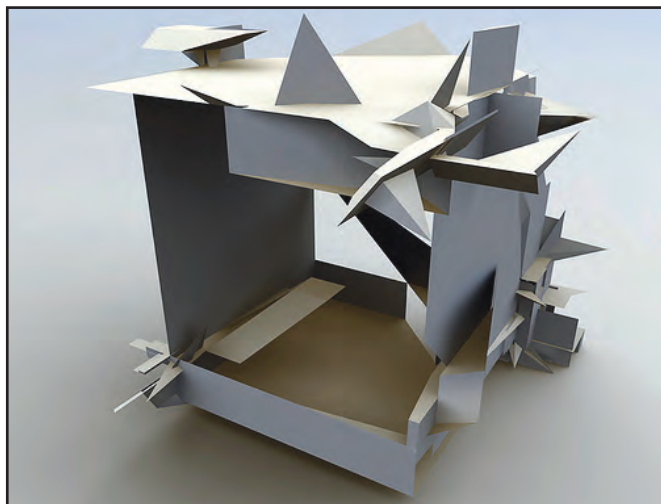


Spam Architecture



Visualisation of data is an enthusiast hobby, and there are some amazing examples around. This piece is from the artist Alex Dragulescu, and is generated by converting various aspects of spam into architectural plans. The project is simply described as "various patterns, keywords and rhythms found in the text are translated into three-dimensional modeling gestures." More visualisations and other projects can be found at www.sq.ro.

Mosquitoes become anaesthetists



If Professor Shigeto Yoshida from (where else?) Japan, has his way, then mosquitoes will immunize people against malaria and other diseases, instead of spreading them. This bizarre use of technology is to replace some of the cells in the salivary glands of the mosquito, with cells that produce the vaccine against malaria. This may be novel, and creative, and we are sure you are already busy extrapolating other possibilities of the technology, but one of the biggest worries is the affect to the biosphere when such transgenic insects are released to the wild. Additionally, there would be no medical supervision over the amount of bites, the dosage administered, and possible allergic reactions from individuals. However, the approach is radical, and solves a number of problems at once, turning the principle vector of the disease into the cure.

NEWS

YouTube - Viacom courtroom drama

This one is about as strange as it can get, and it is not some hack company claiming rights over some obscure pieces of code this time around. Two of the biggest, and most powerful companies in the world are fighting it out in court, and things are getting ugly. Viacom filed a US\$ 1 Billion suite against Google's video uploading and sharing service, YouTube, alleging that a number of videos present on YouTube were infringing on the copyright of the content that belonged to Viacom. The case has been going on since 2007, and there is a fresh twist to the tale. The YouTube representative in court alleged that the copyright was infringed by the copyright owners themselves. They claim that Viacom had been paying people to take content that belonged to Viacom, change the quality of the content to make it look amateurish, and then upload the content on to YouTube. YouTube alleges that there were a number of marketing agencies put to work in this manner, as it would help Viacom win the case. Maybe someone should inform both Viacom and YouTube about ISOHunt.



Stackopolis is a very addictive flash game that is pretty challenging. The gameplay is similar to tetris, but the blocks are already on the floor when the game starts. You just have to pick them up and re-arrange them according to a template shown on the left. The levels get increasingly complicated.

digitDIARY

Rossi's speaker test changed the local environment a bit. The frequency sweeps gave the local vets a hard time, and there were bits where synchronised outbursts of agonized howling from dogs all around. A few bats and pigeons literally tumbled out of the skies. Some of the lower range sweeps ended up making the whole building rumble, and Siddarth is pretty sure he saw the neighbouring building sway just a bit. When it was over, there was a ringing sensation in everyone's ears for about a week. The only person not affected in the team was Michael, who we suspect is immune to sound pollution.

The team has finally abandoned Quake III for good - at least for the time being. Regular readers would have probably seen Quake III mentioned here for nine years now, and the team has never stopped this tradition - till Rossi pulled out his rails last month that is. We have still not recovered, and we're still looking for someone to better Rossi at railing.